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In a .gitattributes file, what does "* -crlf" mean?

In a .gitattributes file, the entry `* -crlf` means that Git should not automatically convert line endings to CRLF (carriage return, line feed) when checking out files.

Here's what each part of the entry means:

- `*` : This wildcard symbol (`*`) applies the rule to all files in the repository.
- `-crlf` : This part indicates that Git should not perform CRLF (carriage return, line feed) line ending conversion for the files matching the wildcard (`*`).

CRLF line endings are commonly used in Windows environments, while Unix-like systems (such as Linux and macOS) typically use LF (line feed) alone. By specifying `-crlf`, you're essentially telling Git not to automatically adjust line endings when checking out files, which can be useful if you're working in a mixed environment or want to preserve line endings as they are originally stored in the repository.

And what does "* text eol=lf" mean?

In a .gitattributes file, the entry `* text eol=lf` specifies that all files in the repository should be treated as text files, and their line endings should be converted to LF (line feed) when they are normalized.

Here's what each part of the entry means:

- `*` : The wildcard symbol `*` applies the rule to all files in the repository.
- `text` : This attribute indicates that the files should be treated as text files rather than binary files. Treating files as text enables Git to perform line ending normalization.
- `eol=lf` : This part specifies the end-of-line (EOL) style to be used. In this case, it's specifying LF (line feed) as the end-of-line character. This means that when the files

are checked out on any platform, Git will ensure that the line endings are LF, regardless of the platform's native line ending convention.

This configuration is useful for ensuring consistent line endings across different platforms and avoiding issues related to line ending inconsistencies in collaborative development environments.